SPE-229317-MS

Best of Both: Leveraging a Diverse Team to Deliver Better Unconventional Developments

Sarah E. Trend, Alex V. Volkov, and Antonio S. Buono, ExxonMobil Upstream Company, Spring, TX, USA; Steven W. Meier, ExxonMobil Technology and Engineering Company, Spring, TX, USA; Vitalis C. Nzerem, ExxonMobil Upstream Company, Spring, TX, USA

 DOI 10.2118/229317-MS

This paper was prepared for presentation at the ADIPEC held in Abu Dhabi, UAE, 3 – 6 November 2025.

Abstract

In an era of increased consolidation within the oil and gas industry, harnessing the collective intelligence of newly merged teams has become essential to unlocking business value. ExxonMobil's "Best of Both" integration approach following its acquisition of Pioneer Natural Resources highlights how deliberate cultural design, shared leadership, and reciprocal learning enabled the team to achieve results neither legacy organization could have delivered alone. A case study of the subsurface technical team illustrates how blending expertise, fostering collaboration, and using behavioral insight tools encouraged mutual respect and shared purpose, and delivered superior technical outcomes.

The business impact of this approach is evident less than two years post-merger. Advanced modelling and simulation have delivered significant value via enhanced development planning. Operational safety, regulatory compliance, and sustainability have been elevated through a dual-framework strategy for managing induced seismicity and water disposal risks. In enhanced oil recovery, the combination of field trial data with theoretical insights has accelerated optimization of future trials and expanded applicability across the Permian Basin. These results demonstrate that an inclusive culture is a strategic imperative – driving innovation, preserving talent, and capturing value in complex environments.

Background

The business benefits of diversity have been recognized for many years, with many best-seller books focused on collective intelligence, diversity, and decision making, such as Surowiecki's [2004] *Wisdom of Crowds: Why the many are smarter than the few and how collective wisdom shapes business, economics, and nations*, or Page's [2017] *The Diversity Bonus: how great teams pay off in the knowledge economy*. McKinsey's most recent *Diversity Matters* study [Hunt et al, 2023] demonstrates that companies with diverse leadership teams are associated with higher financial returns across industries and regions.

Diverse groups, however, are prone to misalignment, miscommunication, tension, and us-versus-them mentalities, which risks companies' abilities to capture the incremental value diversity brings. Diversity alone is unlikely to add value without the context of an inclusive culture in which each colleague feels valued for their uniqueness while also feeling like a trusted member of the group [Bourke, 2016]. One of the largest threats to a sense of group belonging is affinity bias, or the similar-to-me effect [Pilat & Sekoul, 2021] where people are favorably biased toward others like themselves, often giving preferential treatment to members of their own "in group." While all teams risk developing cliques, the risk of a team splitting along diversity lines may be highest following a corporate acquisition, when both the acquiring company and acquired company will define distinct "in" and "out" groups.

Multiple studies show that 70-90% of M&A transactions fail or underperform [Christensen et al, 2011], with an estimated 30% failing due to cultural misalignment [Black et al, 2024]. Average employee turnover following a merger is 47% within the first year and 75% within three years following the deal [Scantlebury, 2024], however, talent retention is critical to merger success [Nahass & Shipman, 2023]. Bain's 2025 M&A Report [Baird et al, 2025] indicates that the "best acquirers consider opportunities to transform both the buyer and target companies to deliver new value" and that a focus on team culture is essential to avoid eroding deal value.

Consolidation in the oil and gas industry has increased in the past few years, with approximately 550 deals occurring globally in each year from 2022-2024 [Bredthauer et al, 2025]. With oil and gas operations characterized by complexity, capital intensity, and high potential risks, it is easy to understand how culture could be perceived as less urgent post-deal, however, managing culture is critical to success [Fantaguzzi and Handscomb, 2024].

This case study demonstrates meaningful business value achieved post-acquisition via a focus on creating an inclusive culture to maximize the benefits of collective intelligence.

ExxonMobil Acquisitions

Exxon Mobil Corporation's (ExxonMobil) growth in United States unconventional resource plays has largely arisen through small and large acquisitions over the past 15 years. Through those years, ExxonMobil has strategically chosen to employ different approaches to integrate companies and assets.

ExxonMobil's first large-scale growth into unconventional resources was the acquisition of XTO Energy Inc. (XTO) in 2010. At the time, XTO was recognized as a leading U.S. unconventional natural gas producer with an outstanding resource base, strong technical expertise, and highly skilled employees [ExxonMobil, 2009]. ExxonMobil created a new division to focus on global development and production of unconventional resources that combined "XTO's skills, capabilities, and asset base with ExxonMobil's advanced research and development and operational capabilities, global scale, and financial capacity" [ExxonMobil, 2010]. The new organization continued to be known as XTO Energy Inc and maintained its head office location separate from ExxonMobil's existing offices. Nearly all XTO's employees transitioned to the new organization.

In 2017, ExxonMobil acquired companies owned by the Bass family, more than doubling its Permian Basin resource. Most of the Bass companies' assets were managed by third-party contractors, meaning no large-scale integration of companies was needed. The Bass assets and limited employees were folded into the XTO portfolio.

ExxonMobil announced its acquisition of Pioneer Natural Resources (Pioneer) on October 11th, 2023, and closed the transaction on May 3rd, 2024, following extensive transition planning and regulatory approval. This transaction more than doubled ExxonMobil's acreage position and production in the Permian Basin (Figure 1). The deal was described in the press release as a unique opportunity to "combine Pioneer's differentiated Permian inventory and basin knowledge with ExxonMobil's proprietary technologies, financial resources, and industry-leading project development." [ExxonMobil, 2023].

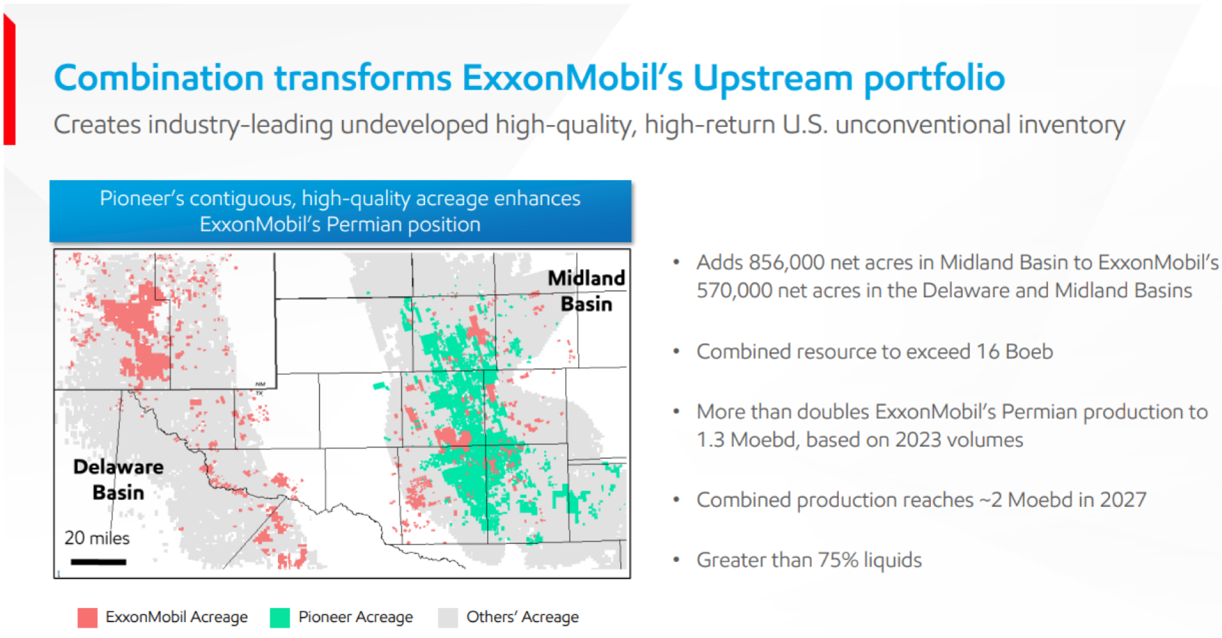

Figure 1—Content from investor presentation released on day of merger announcement.

ExxonMobil recognized that rapid integration of the two companies would be essential to maximizing value capture of the deal but had not completed any large-scale corporate integration since the merger of Exxon and Mobil in 1999. Therefore, ExxonMobil retained an external consulting firm to provide additional insights and staffed an integration "clean team" to prepare for deal closure. This integration team carefully evaluated the capabilities within Pioneer and compared them to ExxonMobil, recognizing that each company had complementary strengths and competitive advantages.

Unlike a traditional acquisition in which the acquired company is likely to adopt all the acquirer's systems and tools, or the XTO model in which the acquired company's systems remained in place, to achieve the best possible outcomes the "Best of Both" approach was developed. The integration team made specific recommendations: in some cases, the ExxonMobil approach was retained, in some the Pioneer approach was adopted and expanded across the entire ExxonMobil unconventional portfolio, and for several choices it was deemed most effective to take the best elements from each approach and design something new.

Central to this approach – as well as critical for maintaining ongoing operations - was the necessity of retaining Pioneer's employees and ensuring their expertise and perspectives were present and visible at all levels of the combined organization. More than 90% of Pioneer employees were offered roles within ExxonMobil, significantly above the average 70% typically retained after a merger or acquisition [Marks et al., 2017]. The new organization design contemplated balanced leadership appointments, targeting 50% leaders from ExxonMobil and 50% from Pioneer in the Permian business unit to ensure perspective from both sides, learning in both directions, and better morale. The CEO of Pioneer was named the leader of the Permian business unit.

ExxonMobil had retained the XTO brand for the unconventional business unit after its acquisition in 2010 but chose to retire its usage coincident with the Pioneer deal closure, demonstrating commitment to creating one organization and culture under a single brand: ExxonMobil. In addition to ensuring balanced representation of leadership, individual teams were thoughtfully constructed to blend employees from each organization and avoid an "us" and "them" mindset.

Simply building a blended organization would not ensure immediate collaboration and success, so leaders were coached on their critical role in building an inclusive environment. Culture surveys and focus groups were employed to better understand and communicate cultural differences. Team members were encouraged to understand the diversity of perspective and approach of their colleagues, and the organization employed deliberate methods of debate to counteract bias and increase the number of ideas considered.

Case Study: Subsurface Technical Team

The subsurface technical team comprises approximately 50 geoscientists and reservoir engineers who are experts in their fields, such as geochemistry, reservoir characterization, and rate-transient analysis. Maintaining this capability within ExxonMobil at such a scale provides a significant competitive advantage. The team provides specialist subsurface support to business unit teams, including regional studies, fracture modelling, reservoir simulation, and reserves reporting. The original team was made up of an exact 50 / 50 split between ExxonMobil and Pioneer employees and leaders, with the overall subsurface technical manager from ExxonMobil. Each of the four sub-teams was not evenly split, however, the organizational design intentionally ensured a mix of employees on each team (Figure 2).

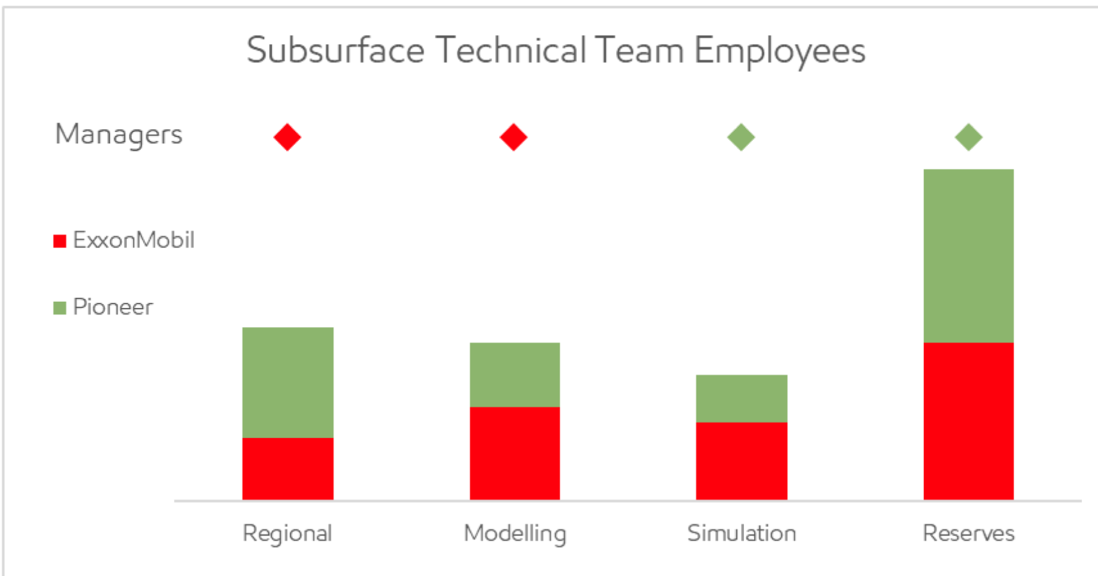

Figure 2—Split of employees from each legacy organization across subsurface technical team sub-teams. The overall subsurface technical manager was an ExxonMobil employee. The original Simulation team manager was a Pioneer employee who did not accept long-term employment with ExxonMobil but remained in position to support transition and integration for the first few months.

Ensuring a mixed distribution of employees was the first step, but not enough to ensure effective collaboration and integration. Each sub-team took its own approach to foster effective working relationships and ensure common understanding.

The regional team held early workshops to provide onboarding / offboarding for ongoing high-priority operations, particularly for induced seismicity monitoring, appraisal drilling, and data acquisition. Given the focus change from Pioneer's single-basin operations, the team introduced a joint work management system for inventorying and prioritizing their ongoing projects, in addition to identifying and tracking additional value-add opportunities that were not currently resourced. The wide variety of projects this team stewards warranted the implementation of bi-weekly project updates and discussions of upcoming work to ensure continuous alignment and clarity as well as sharing of best practices.

The modelling and simulation teams, whose work products are closely linked, quickly conducted a series of eight technical workshops. These sessions were designed to explore not just workflows, but the underlying assumptions, data, and decision-making frameworks of each team. This collaborative, technically driven process was led by the technical leads (not managers) from both companies, working together to identify similarities, bridge gaps, and align on a shared vision. By focusing on the technical drivers behind decisions, the workshops helped mitigate any sense of corporate or personal bias. Both teams acknowledged that their independent conclusions were based on the best available data, but that data was incomplete; together they reached better conclusions than either could have alone. Even workshop logistics were equitable, with the location alternating between each company's office, as most Pioneer employees had not yet begun relocation from Dallas to Houston. The result was a team that organically grew into a unified organization, focused on technical excellence rather than legacy structures.

ExxonMobil and Pioneer's reserves teams had different structures, with Pioneer's centralized reserves teams conducting all analysis and ExxonMobil employing a small, centralized team to ensure consistency and quality after business unit teams conducted their own analyses. Given the criticality of accurate reserves reporting, the new joint reserves team wanted to ensure stability and integrity through year end. To this end, each team maintained their existing approach but collaborated through 2024 to understand the benefits of each method and jointly design the "Best of Both" team structure which was implemented in 2025. The restructured team kicked off 2025 with a series of workshops to review all pertinent data related to reserves assessment and continue the integration of our industry-leading well and production data sets, particularly for the Permian Basin, to identify additional insights that may inform the year's reserves.

In addition to each sub-team's activities, the entire subsurface technical team came together for a 2-day workshop to jointly define a mission statement, vision, and commitments for 2025 aligned with the unconventional business line's goals. The team has also employed various tools to better understand each other's working styles and preferences, such as the DiSC profile [Scullard and Baum, 2015], or Crucial Learning's "Strength Deployment Inventory" (SDI) (Figure 3). These tools provide insights into each person's motives, strengths, and behavioral styles, enabling each team member to better understand both their own work style and that of their colleagues.

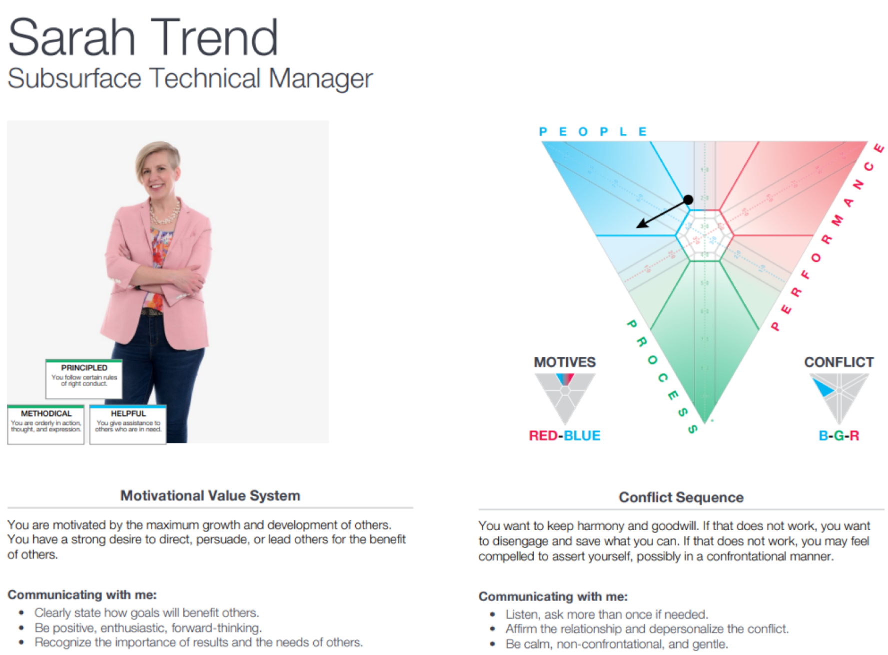

Figure 3—Sample portion of an individual Core Strengths profile, which highlights core motives, strengths, how a person experiences conflict, and how strengths can be overdone, limiting interpersonal effectiveness. Photo credit: Al Torres Photography.

The subsurface technical team does not work in isolation but also collaborates with several teams across ExxonMobil and industry. To maximize effectiveness, the team shares its mission and vision broadly, and individuals share their SDI profiles. Team members embrace and actively participate in technical workshops designed to learn from "cold eyes" perspectives, mitigate bias, and ensure broad discussion.

These efforts have together fostered a culture of mutual respect and shared purpose. This highly integrated team shares a strong commitment to using tools and insights from both heritage organizations, continuous learning, supporting each other, and having fun. Most importantly, the "Best of Both" approach has created significant value and yielded superior business outcomes than either organization could have achieved independently.

Business Results

Across ExxonMobil's entire unconventional business line, "Best of Both" results are driving efficiency and capturing value, delivering all 2024 plans and progressing delivery of 2025 plans, as well. Notably, the team achieved record Permian Basin production of 1.6 million oil-equivalent barrels per day in 2Q2025 and are on track to capture more than $3 billion of synergies. Within the subsurface technical space some key highlights are in modelling and simulation, management of induced seismicity, and growing our understanding of enhanced oil recovery.

Modelling and Simulation

The technical workshops held by the modelling and simulation teams resulted in a transformation of how unconventional development is understood, modelled, and executed. Before the merger, ExxonMobil's team began integrating machine leaning and AI into its modelling workflows, whereas Pioneer had built basin-wide geologic models. Both organizations had deep, though slightly different, expertise in fracture modelling and simulation. Combining modelling and production data and insights from both sides enabled the team to build a more holistic understanding of the key inputs and outputs that drive decision making in unconventional development. For instance, each company's regional geological model was combined into a single integrated model that served as input to machine learning models, which deliver more reliable outcomes from the larger data set.

Subsurface modelling efforts were grounded in foundational data sources, including seismic surveys, production and completion data from operated wells, and formation evaluation (FE) models calibrated to core data. The merger nearly doubled the quantity of Midland Basin well data (Figure 4), resulting in a significantly improved FE model.

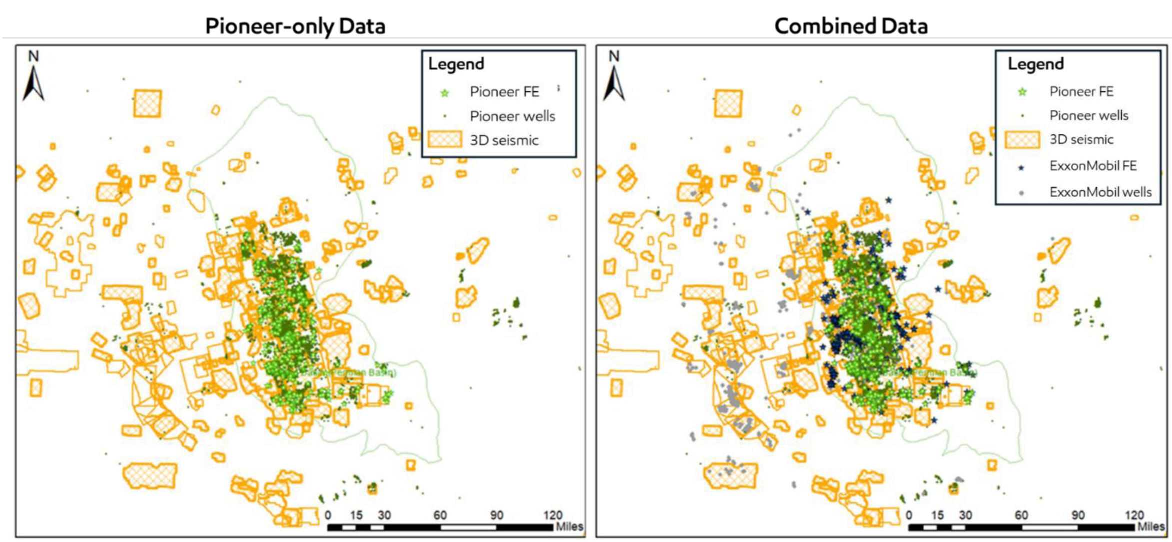

Figure 4—Midland Basin data coverage: map on the left shows Pioneer-only data whereas the map on the right shows the combined ExxonMobil-Pioneer data set. The combined data set nearly doubles the number of wells available and increases 3D seismic coverage more than 50%.

Even with this increase in well and FE data, seismic data are critical to extrapolate and predict rock properties between well control. While Pioneer and ExxonMobil had licensed several of the same 3D seismic data sets, Pioneer owned approximately 1,500 square miles of proprietary seismic data. This was integrated with the existing licensed data to create a merged seismic volume covering the core of the basin. This volume was then combined with well data to create a high-resolution geo-cellular model that enables detailed geologic property extraction and forms the basis for enhanced fracture/stimulation modelling; the availability of geo-cellular properties significantly improves the ability to simulate fracture behavior and evaluate spacing and stacking designs, including parent-child well interactions (Figure 5).

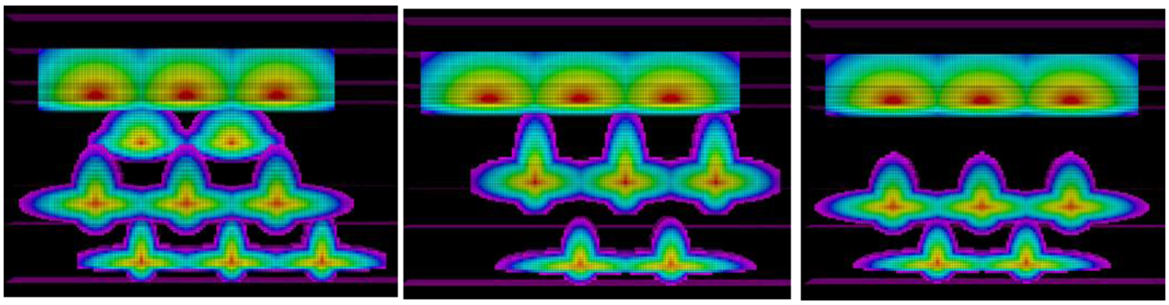

Figure 5—Example fracture modelling comparing three different cube designs. The left-most design evaluates an 11-well configuration across 4 benches, whereas the middle and right designs test 8-well configurations across differing sets of 3 benches. All three designs are viable; however, each design is evaluated for its impact on drainage volume, cost, and other parameters such that the development can be optimized for value, capital efficiency, and cash flow.

To further enhance decision making, a large-scale machine learning initiative was launched. This effort integrated the geo-cellular model with production and completions data, enabling rapid, data-driven evaluation while minimizing biases. The team can focus the detailed fracture modelling and simulation efforts on a sub-set of specific development scenarios while the machine learning model efficiently tests a wider range of scenarios in parallel.

In 2024 alone the team delivered $350M of value through improved spacing/stacking/completion recommendations made via deployment of advanced modelling and simulation in development planning. This value stems directly from changes in development strategy and execution enabled by the new integrated workflow. For example:

- Geologic modelling is now integrated earlier in the process, allowing for more accurate subsurface characterization
- Fracture modelling and simulation are informed by a broader data set and more diverse experimental history
- Machine learning and AI are used to analyze the spread of possible outcomes, improving confidence in development decisions

These capabilities, made possible by a unified team, are already delivering meaningful results, and the team anticipates even greater value as these tools mature and are fully deployed across the 2026-2027 development timeframe.

Induced Seismicity and Water Management

Another standout example of the "Best of Both" approach is the integration of ExxonMobil's global expertise in induced seismicity management with Pioneer's deep operational knowledge of shallow saltwater disposal (SWD) in the Permian Basin. Each company leaned into its own strengths: Pioneer historically prioritized proactive monitoring and geological characterization; ExxonMobil prioritized tool and workflow development.

Each approach was effective, but together, they form a more complete approach including characterization, monitoring, and modelling; by combining these complementary capabilities, the team has significantly advanced its ability to manage and mitigate subsurface injection-related risks through a dual-framework strategy.

The first of these frameworks, focused on induced seismicity, is already fully established and deployed across the Permian basin. To manage the risks associated with subsurface fluid injection, the team has co-developed a unified strategy built around four key pillars: Risking, Monitoring & Response, Capability Development, and Stakeholder Engagement (Figure 6). These pillars enable data-driven decision making, proactive mitigation, and long-term value protection across the company's unconventional development portfolio. This system supports dynamic risk mitigation by informing well placement and injection strategies, reducing the likelihood of seismic events while maintaining operational efficiency. The robust, basin-wide risk management framework enhances regulatory compliance, safeguards community trust, and ensures long-term sustainability.

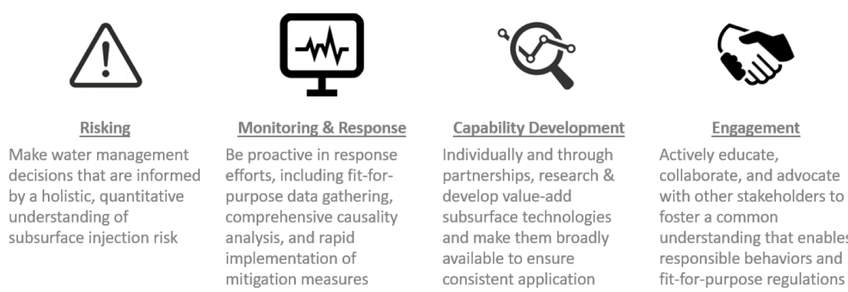

Figure 6—Induced seismicity risking workflow with tiered assessment framework.

Risking. The risking pillar comprises multiple types of structured seismic risk assessments. Making informed decisions about water injection and disposal begins with a holistic understanding of seismic risk. The team employs a tiered risk assessment framework (Figure 7), enabling consistent evaluation of potential impacts at multiple levels of resolution, including: 1. Screening-level risking for rapid screening of new SWD proposals or expansion areas; 2. Standard risking, using fault proximity, injection history, subsurface stress regimes and other data to quantify the likelihood of induced seismic events at specific locations; and 3. Probabilistic Seismic Risk Assessment, which integrates a variety of factors to evaluate not just the likelihood of seismicity but also the expected magnitude and consequences, which enables risk-based operational planning.

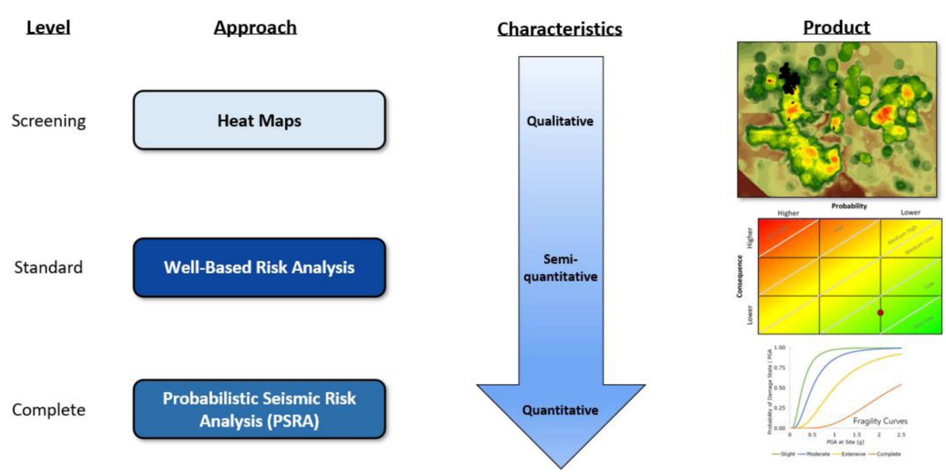

Figure 7—Integrated seismicity monitoring and response risk management framework.

Monitoring and Response. Risking is only as effective as the response mechanisms it supports. The team maintains proactive and adaptive response protocols that align with regulatory expectations, community standards, and industry best practices. Elements of this pillar include regional collaboration with other stakeholders, magnitude-driven action plans, integrated causality analysis of each seismic event, and partnerships with academic institutions and technical consortia to ensure mitigation strategies are backed by research.

Capability Development. Maintaining leadership in seismic risk management requires continual investment in tools, workflows, and partnerships. Current initiatives include enhanced geomechanical modelling tools, machine learning applications, ensuring consistency across business units, and collaborating with universities, regulators, and industry groups to pilot new approaches and share learnings.

Stakeholder Engagement. The final pillar ensures that subsurface risk mitigation is not only technically sound but also aligned with stakeholder expectations. The team actively educates regulators, community leaders, and personnel on seismicity science and mitigation strategies; collaborates with peer educators to establish shared risk thresholds, communication protocols, and joint action plans; and supports the development of fit-for-purpose regulations that reflect both geological complexity and operational realities.

By combining predictive analytics, proactive response, robust technical capabilities, and transparent stakeholder engagement, the combined ExxonMobil and Pioneer team's "Best of Both" philosophy has created a best-in-class approach to managing subsurface seismicity injection-related risk. This integrated framework is already supporting safer, more sustainable development across the Permian Basin and beyond—and will serve as a foundation for long-term resilience as operations evolve.

The team is leveraging this framework and their combined expertise to develop a similarly rigorous framework for managing risks associated with shallow SWD. Building on Pioneer's extensive experience with disposal operations and monitoring infrastructure, this emerging framework is designed to address a range of critical risk variables including containment loss, drilling complexity, formation acidification, and constraints on disposal capacity.

By structuring these considerations into a formal risk assessment process, the team is enhancing its ability to make informed, basin-wide decisions that balance technical performance, environmental stewardship, and long-term asset integrity. This dual-framework approach exemplifies how deliberate integration of legacy strengths can yield more resilient and forward-looking water management strategies.

Enhanced Oil Recovery

Both ExxonMobil and Pioneer had directed efforts on unconventional enhanced oil recovery (EOR) technology. A long-standing challenge in unconventional development is how to increase and extend production of unconventional oil wells, which are typically characterized as having relatively steep production declines following initially high flow rates, resulting in relatively lower oil recovery compared to conventional assets (Figure 8). When the teams met for early workshops, they observed that each organization had arrived at similar conclusions but had employed different approaches from different starting points. Similar to the induced seismicity example above, Pioneer had advanced more field trials, particularly in surfactant EOR, collecting data and drawing conclusions to direct next steps. In contrast, ExxonMobil's technical organization focused on theory first, evaluating the fundamental limiters to enhancing production, developing hypotheses, and starting to test and evaluate.

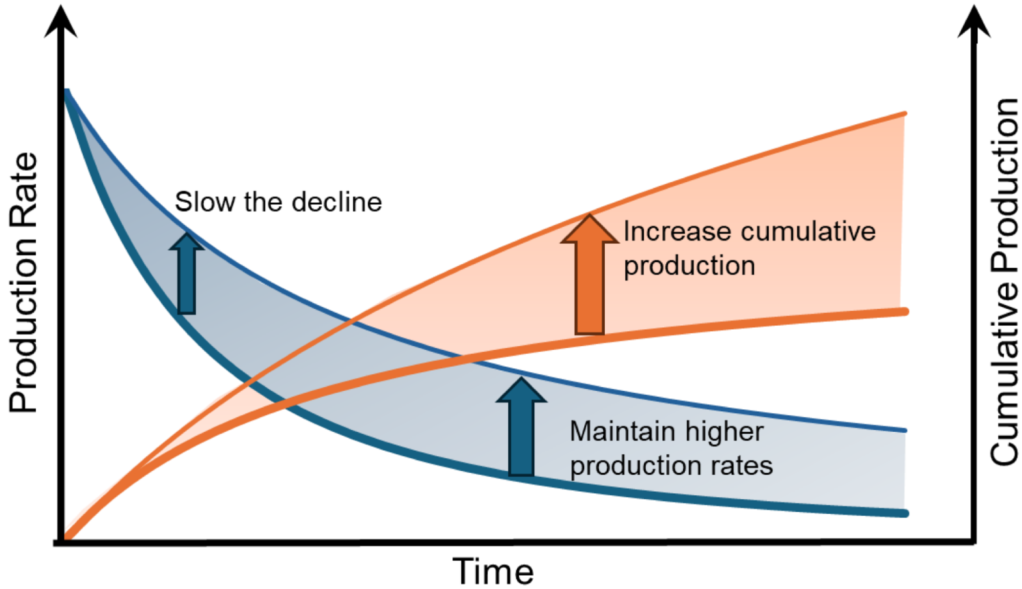

Figure 8—The goal of EOR is to improve recovery by slowing production rate decline and sustaining higher rates to increase cumulative production.

This combination of complementary learnings enabled speed and strength as EOR trials moved forward. The integrated team accelerated technology by utilizing the strength of lab and modelling work to help fill in the gaps hypothesized from field test results while also using those field test learnings to inform what the next set of experiments and models should be.

In surfactant EOR, the early field trials from Pioneer guided the combined team to reduce options to those with the greatest early value and scalability. ExxonMobil's focus on fundamentals supported expansion of insights to the broader combined Permian acreage position. These new better-optimized field trials will also benefit from early engagement with ExxonMobil Product Solutions.

Both ExxonMobil and Pioneer had executed their first gas-based, or "Huff & Puff," EOR field trials and were planning their next, larger-scale trials. Leveraging advanced experimental [Alzobaidi et al., 2022], analytical, and modelling insights, combined with complementary learnings from the different pilot approaches, the combined organization has developed an accelerated unified trial strategy aimed at unlocking opportunities for ExxonMobil's contiguous acreage.

Conclusions

Mergers and acquisitions carry meaningful risks but also create significant enterprise value. Post-deal corporate culture is a critical factor in creating a sense of inclusion for team members which, in turn, will drive better decisions and improve technical outcomes. Organizations will foster a greater sense of belonging, which will create greater business value, by deliberately designing inclusive environments and avoiding an us-versus-them mindset. ExxonMobil's "Best of Both" approach following the acquisition of Pioneer is a solid case study demonstrating the early value of thoughtful, intentional integration to create an entity that delivers greater value than the sum of its parts.

Acknowledgements

We appreciate all ExxonMobil and Pioneer team members for their enthusiastic collaboration and willingness to embrace change during a period of significant upheaval, with special thanks to the Subsurface Technical Team for sharing their specific examples. We thank ExxonMobil for permission to present this work and publish this paper.

References

Alzobaidi, S., Kortunov, P., Chhatre, S., Chen, A., Guice, K., Baier, K., Messner, M., Leiphart, J., Laverick, L., Longoria, R., Valenza, J., Meier, S., and Rainey, J. "Experimental Evaluation of Huff and Puff EOR Mechanisms in Unconventional Rock." Paper presented at the SPE/AAPG/SEG Unconventional Resources Technology Conference, Houston, Texas, USA, June 2022. doi: https://doi.org/10.15530/urtec-2022-3719062

Baird, L., Harding, D., Stafford, D., Grass, K., Kumar, S., Relzak, R., and Diamond, D., 2025. *Global M&A Report 2025: How leaders are adapting to meet the moment*. Bain.

Black, J., Helsop, B., and McCoy, C., 2024. *Mitigating Culture Risk to Drive Deal Value*. Mercer.

Bourke, J, 2016. *Which two heads are better than one? How diverse teams create breakthrough ideas and make smarter decisions*. Australian Institute of Company Directors.

Bredthauer, C., Butler, R., Bridges, T.O., Goldberg, I.R., Goodgame, J., Jabsheh, W., Lascelles, S., Lovely, M.W., Rootsey, S., Shearer, W.R., and Williams, W.P., 2025. *Oil & Gas in 2025: Emerging Trends & Predictions*. Akin Gump Strauss Hauer & Feld LLP.

Christensen, C.M., Alton, R., Rising, C., and Waldeck, A., 2011. *The Big Idea: The New M&A Playbook*, Harvard Business Review Magazine, March 2011.

ExxonMobil, 2009. *Exxon Mobil Corporation and XTO Energy Inc. Announce Agreement*. Press release December 14th, 2009.

ExxonMobil, 2010. *ExxonMobil Announces Completion of All-Stock Transaction for XTO*. Press release June 25th, 2010.

Fantaguzzi, I., and Handscomb, C., 2024. *The importance of cultural integration in M&A: The path to success*. McKinsey.

Marks, M.L, Mirvis, P, and Ashkenas, R., 2017. Surviving M&A, Harvard Business Review Magazine, March-April 2017.

Hunt, V., Dixon-Fyle, S., Huber, C., del Mar Martinez Marquez, M., Prince, S., and Thomas, A., 2023. *Diversity Matters Even More: The case for holistic impact*. McKinsey.

Page, E., 2017 *The Diversity Bonus: How great teams pay off in the Knowledge Economy*. Princeton University Press.

Pilat, D., and Sekoul, K., 2021. *The Similar-To-Me Effect*. The Decision Lab. Retrieved August 3, 2025, from https://thedecisionlab.com/reference-guide/psychology/the-similar-to-me-effect

Nahass, G., and Shipman, B., 2023. *Transact to Transform: PwC's 2023 M&A Integration Survey*. PwC.

Scantlebury, Shaun, 2024. *How culture can unlock M&A performance*. EY.

Scullard, M., Howard, A., and Salcedo, J., 2025. *Everything DiSC Manual*. Wiley publishing.

Surowiecki, J., 2005 *Wisdom of Crowds: Why the many are smarter than the few and how collective wisdom shapes business, economies, and nations*. Knopf Doubleday Publishing Group.